

Question 21 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain the structure of an HRD system and describe its major components.

Introduction

A system is a set of parts that work together for a purpose. An HRD system is therefore not a training calendar hanging on a wall. It is an organised arrangement of beliefs, mechanisms, people and information that continuously develops individuals, boss–subordinate pairs (dyads), teams, and the organisation as a whole.

The notes insist that HRD is a process, not merely a bag of techniques. Techniques such as performance appraisal, counselling, training and organisation development are used to initiate, facilitate and promote that process. Because the process has no limit, the mechanisms must be examined periodically to see whether they are promoting or hindering development. Structure means how these parts are arranged and linked — like organs of one body, not like separate shops in a market.

Detailed points

- 1. Foundation of the structure — philosophy and goals.** At the base are beliefs that people have potential and that development is planned and valued. Goals of the HRD system, from the notes, include: capabilities of each employee as an individual; in the present role; in expected future roles; the dyadic relationship with the supervisor; team spirit in every unit; collaboration among units; and the organisation's overall health and self-renewing capability. If this foundation is missing, later components become disconnected activities that fill files but do not develop anyone.
- 2. Performance appraisal as a central component.** This is a planned review of results and behaviours. In an HRD structure it is developmental: it clarifies the role, identifies strengths and gaps, and leads to an improvement plan. It is not only a confidential mark for increment. Appraisal sits near the centre because it regularly generates information for other components.
- 3. Potential appraisal.** This component looks forward: can this person take a larger or different responsibility? It prevents the organisation from promoting people only because they are excellent in the present job (a specialist may fail as a manager). Potential appraisal feeds career planning and succession.
- 4. Training and development.** Planned learning to close gaps and to prepare for future work. It includes training (job skills), education (concepts and judgement) and longer development. In the structure, training is a component that receives needs from appraisal and TNA and returns people to the workplace where other components must support transfer.
- 5. Career planning.** A continuous mapping of possible paths from entry toward later roles, integrating individual aspirations with organisational needs. Notes call it a blueprint, a process not an event, and a means of managing people for optimum results. It uses potential data and specifies what training and job experiences are required.
- 6. Feedback, counselling, and OD/climate mechanisms.** Feedback gives specific information on behaviour and results. Counselling is a helping conversation about problems, emotions and choices so the person can decide and change. Organisation development, team building and climate work develop groups and the whole organisation's health — which the notes say must also be covered by development. These are the human and cultural components of the structure.
- 7. Supporting structure — roles, records and HRM links.** HRD specialists design and facilitate; line managers develop people daily; top management sponsors. There must be records (competencies, IDPs, training history). Links to HRM — placement, promotion, pay — must be consistent, otherwise HRD messages are cancelled by reward messages. Structure includes these supports, not only the six famous mechanisms.

8. Interrelation is itself part of structure. The parts must form a cycle: goals → performance → feedback/counselling → potential and career → training and experiences → new performance. A review loop checks whether mechanisms help or hinder the HRD process. A student who only lists components without saying they are linked has not explained structure.

Conclusion. Define HRD as a system with a philosophy at the base. Describe components: appraisal, potential, training, career, feedback/counselling, OD/climate, plus roles and information. Stress that structure means linkage and a review loop, not a pile of forms. Close: the HRD system develops people at many levels so that the organisation can renew itself.